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Submitter Information

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General Comment

Thank you for this opportunity to comment.

While I understand it is important to keep up with the rapid growth of technological advancement and for the United States of America to properly compete with other countries in these fields, my concerns today are for the individual and the small business owners.

To my friends, I once compared the dawn of A.I. to Frankenstein's monster or the dinosaurs of "Jurassic Park." The scientific geniuses did not stop to think of the long-term (or even short-term) ramifications these acts could have on the individual. They only saw and thought about how their advancements could help others or be beneficial to mankind in some way. While that is noble, it does not change the dangers and very real threat A.I. places on the individual.

A.I. is growing rapidly. In fact, probably too rapidly. On top of the already very real threat of deepfakes, which has and will give rise to defamations of all kinds, as well as allow scammers and criminals to take advantage of others who may lack the tools necessary to detect such scams, the concern that A.I. will invade the lives of and steal from hard-working citizens is also very real.

For many months now, the tech companies and now the White House has championed the advancement of A.I. and how it will vastly improve the lives of Americans and possibly the world. But what protections are you offering us? What safeguards are there to prevent our jobs from being taken? What is stopping corporate chiefs and CEOs from replacing middle class or lower class workers with A.I.? Where does that leave us? What guarantees can you give us that this will either not happen or there will be some form of worthwhile compensation provided? We already have plenty of struggling Americans in this country, and I fear unleashing this big tech on us will only generate more unless something is done to prevent it.

And what of the concern that copyright protections will be considered null through some form of legislation all in the name of progress? Hundreds if not thousands if not millions of peoples' hard work and innovation (American innovation), devoured by these soulless machines, again, all in the name of progress and so that big tech can have an excuse to plunder our hard work. The individual is steam-rolled over by big tech getting a free pass. And what do we get out of it? The promise of a glorified America, strengthened by A.I.? Okay, fair, it MIGHT lead to medical innovations or breakthroughs in science, but where's that guarantee? The things couldn't even draw hands correctly. On the topic of copyright protection, we might as well not even bother to create once these things are set in motion. Stop drawing your pictures, stop taking your photographs, stop making your movies, stop acting, stop it all. A machine will do it for you. It robs the creator of the joy of creating, and it will rob the audience of authenticity. The heart and soul of creativity will be crushed. And while the creator can still create even with the advent of A.I., it will cut into their profits and it is only a matter of time before their hard work is swallowed up by those same soulless machines, or people using those machines to get ahead. Whereas others spent half their lives developing their skills day after day, now somebody who refuses to put in the work will be able to just type in a prompt and take credit for the work when all they did was click a keyboard for a few minutes. And what promises and safeguards do you have for them, those who have spent years trying to better their talents? I'm sorry, but your word will not be enough.

In closing, I again understand the need to keep up with the technology, so as not to fall behind to rivals on the global stage. But the fear that many will be hurt in the name of this progress is very real. If this needs to be done, if progress must be put forth first, then protections and compensation for the average American and the artistic creators of this country need to be put in place before it happens. Thank you.